

Jira for Beginners – Complete Guide

If you are learning software development, testing, project management, or working in a company, Jira is one of the most important tools to understand.

Think of **Jira as a digital workplace where teams organize, track, and manage their work.**

1. What is Issue Tracking?

What is an Issue?

In Jira, an **Issue** means **any piece of work that needs attention.**

An issue can be:

- A task
- A bug
- A new feature
- An improvement
- A support request

Real-Life Example

Imagine you are building an Online Shopping Website.

Some work items are:

- Create Login Page
- Create Registration Page
- Fix Payment Error
- Add Dark Mode

Each of these becomes an **Issue** in Jira.

Why Issue Tracking is Important?

Without issue tracking:

- ✗ Developers forget tasks
- ✗ Bugs get lost
- ✗ Managers cannot track progress
- ✗ Team members don't know who is working on what

With Jira:

- ✓ Everything is recorded
 - ✓ Tasks are assigned
 - ✓ Progress is visible
 - ✓ Deadlines can be tracked
-

Example Issue

Issue ID: SHOP-101

Title: Create Login Page

Assignee: Rahul

Priority: High

Status: In Progress

Due Date: 20 June

The team can instantly see:

- What needs to be done
 - Who is doing it
 - Current status
-

2. Understanding Project Boards

A **Board** is a visual representation of work.

It helps teams see:

- Pending work
 - Ongoing work
 - Completed work
-

Example Board

| To Do | In Progress | Done |

| Login | Cart Page | Homepage |
| Signup | Payment API | Profile |

Why Boards Are Useful?

Imagine 20 developers working together.

Instead of asking:

"What are you working on?"

Everyone simply checks the board.

Types of Boards in Jira

Scrum Board

Used for Agile development with Sprints.

Backlog

↓

Sprint

↓

Development

↓

Testing

↓

Done

Teams work in fixed durations called **Sprints**.

Usually:

- 1 Week
- 2 Weeks
- 4 Weeks

Kanban Board

Used for continuous work.

To Do

↓

In Progress

↓

Review

↓

Done

No sprint planning.

Work flows continuously.

Often used by:

- Support teams
- Maintenance teams
- Operations teams

3. Understanding Tasks and Tickets

In Jira, people often use the words:

- Task
- Ticket
- Issue

Almost interchangeably.

What is a Ticket?

A ticket is simply a record of work.

Example:

Ticket #123

Add Search Functionality

When someone says:

"I have 5 tickets assigned."

They mean:

"I have 5 work items assigned."

What is a Task?

A task is a type of issue.

Example:

Task:

Create Product Page

Real Project Example

Project:

Online Food Delivery App

Tasks:

Task 1:

Create Login Screen

Task 2:

Create Restaurant List

Task 3:

Create Payment Module

Each task becomes a Jira ticket.

4. Types of Issues in Jira

The most common issue types are:

Epic

A large feature.

Example:

Epic:

User Authentication

Story

A user requirement.

Example:

As a user,

I want to login

so that I can access my account.

Task

Work that needs completion.

Example:

Create Login UI

Bug

Something is broken.

Example:

Login button not working.

Sub-task

Smaller work inside a task.

Example:

Task:

Create Login Page

Subtasks:

- Design UI
 - Create API
 - Connect Database
-

5. How Bugs Are Handled in Jira

A **Bug** is an error or defect in software.

Example Bug

User reports:

Unable to login with valid password.

QA Team creates a bug ticket.

Bug Ticket

Bug ID: BUG-501

Title:

Login Failure

Priority:

Critical

Reported By:

QA Team

Assigned To:

Developer

Bug Workflow

Open



Assigned



In Progress



Testing



Resolved



Closed

Real Example

Step 1

Tester finds issue.

Login button does nothing.

Step 2

Bug is reported in Jira.

BUG-501

Step 3

Developer fixes issue.

Status:

In Progress

Step 4

Tester verifies fix.

Status:

Testing

Step 5

Bug works correctly.

Status:

Closed

6. Important Terms Used in Real Projects

These are terms you'll hear daily in software companies.

Backlog

A list of future work.

Backlog

- Search Feature
 - Chat Feature
 - Notifications
 - Dark Mode
- Not started yet.
-

Sprint

A fixed period of development.

Example:

Sprint 1

Duration:

2 Weeks

Goal:

Complete Login Module

Assignee

Person responsible for work.

Task:

Create Login API

Assignee:

Abhinav

Reporter

Person who created the issue.

Reporter:

Tester

Priority

Importance level.

Highest

High

Medium

Low

Lowest

Status

Current state.

To Do

In Progress

Review

Testing

Done

Release

Version delivered to users.

Example:

Version 1.0

Login

Registration

Profile

7. Complete Real-World Jira Example

Suppose a company is building a Food Delivery App.

Epic

Food Ordering System

Stories

User Login

Restaurant Search

Order Placement

Online Payment

Tasks

Design Login UI

Create Login API

Connect Database

Subtasks

Create Login Form

Validate Inputs

Create Password Encryption

Bug

Login fails after password reset

Board View

| To Do | In Progress | Testing | Done |

| Search | Login API | Payment | Homepage |
| Cart | Restaurant | Profile | Registration |

Typical Jira Workflow in a Company

Requirement Received



Create Epic



Create Stories



Create Tasks



Assign Developers



Development



Testing



Bug Fixing



Release



Done

What You Should Remember

Issue

Any work item in Jira.

Ticket

Another name for an issue.

Task

A specific piece of work.

Bug

A software defect/problem.

Epic

A large feature containing multiple stories.

Story

A user requirement.

Board

Visual view of all work.

Sprint

A fixed development cycle (1–4 weeks).

Backlog

List of future work.

Assignee

Person responsible for completing the work.

Status

Current progress of the work.